Himalaya Crest Realty (Pvt.) Ltd. - Frequently Asked Questions

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Fictional company created for software testing.

1. How to use this document

This document collects the questions that clients of Himalaya Crest Realty (HCR) ask most often. The answers are written in plain language and are grouped by topic: the company, buying, selling, renting, payments, documents, viewings, complaints and local terms. Where a full explanation exists elsewhere, the answer points to the Property Listings, Services and Fees, or Policies and Terms document. If a question is not answered here, the Client Services Centre in Islamabad will be glad to help on +92 51 5550 1002 or at info@himalayacrest.example.

2. About the company

Q1. What kind of company is Himalaya Crest Realty? HCR is a real estate firm based in Islamabad. It helps people buy, sell and rent property, looks after let properties for owners, writes valuation reports, supports the paperwork of a deal and advises investors. Its mission is to keep every transaction clear, documented and fair. Its slogan is "Clear deals, firm ground."

Q2. When was the company started and by whom? Farhan Mirza founded the company on 14 March 2012 in Islamabad. He started with a team of 6. Today he is the Chief Executive Officer, and the company has 86 staff members.

Q3. Where are the offices? There are four offices:

- Head Office: Floor 4, Crest Tower, Summit Road, Business District, Islamabad.
- Rawalpindi Branch: Office 7, Pine Plaza, Garden Road, Rawalpindi.
- Abbottabad Branch: Shop 3, Hill Arcade, Orchard Road, Abbottabad.
- Lahore Branch: Floor 2, Lotus Centre, Canal View Road, Lahore.

Q4. When can I visit or call an office?

Office	Monday to Friday	Saturday	Sunday
Head Office, Islamabad	9:00 am to 6:00 pm	10:00 am to 3:00 pm	Closed
Rawalpindi Branch	9:00 am to 6:00 pm	10:00 am to 3:00 pm	Closed
Abbottabad Branch	9:30 am to 5:30 pm	10:00 am to 2:00 pm	Closed
Lahore Branch	10:00 am to 7:00 pm	10:00 am to 7:00 pm	Closed

Lahore is the only office that stays open until 7:00 pm on a Saturday.

Q5. Is the company licensed? Yes. The corporate registration number is HCR-CR-2012-004417. Each office holds its own real estate agent licence: HCR-REA-ISB-2013-0192 for the Head Office, HCR-REA-RWP-2014-0121 for Rawalpindi, HCR-REA-ATD-2016-0088 for Abbottabad and HCR-REA-LHR-2019-0207 for Lahore. The valuation practice licence is HCR-VAL-2020-0035, and the company's FARP membership number is FARP-2015-3381.

3. Buying

Q6. How do I start if I want to buy a property? Contact the branch that handles the city you are interested in, or write to info@himalayacrest.example. A consultant will ask about your needs, shortlist suitable units, arrange viewings and share the written payment schedule. The same consultant stays as your named contact until the booking is complete.

Q7. How many properties are available right now? The inventory holds 24 properties. At the effective date of this document, 17 are available, 4 are reserved and 3 are sold. Only available properties can be booked. A reserved property has already been booked by another client, and a sold property is shown for reference only.

Q8. What does the company charge a buyer? The buyer pays a buying commission, which is one flat percentage of the full price. The percentage depends on the price band: 2.0% up to PKR 10,000,000, 1.75% from PKR 10,000,001 to PKR 25,000,000, and 1.5% above PKR 25,000,000. The minimum commission is PKR 150,000. An admin fee of PKR 7,500 is added per transaction.

Q9. What would the total company charge be on a PKR 27,500,000 apartment? That price is above PKR 25,000,000, so the rate is 1.5%. The commission is PKR 27,500,000 x 1.5% = PKR 412,500. Adding the admin fee of PKR 7,500 gives PKR 420,000. Documentation support, if wanted, is charged separately.

Q10. I am comparing the two-bedroom apartments in Crest View Residency. What is the difference? The Block A unit (HCR-ISB-0101) costs PKR 18,500,000 and is planned for handover on 30 June 2028. The Block B unit (HCR-ISB-0102) costs PKR 19,200,000 and is planned for handover on 31 December 2028. Both measure 4 marla (1,089 sq ft), have 2 bedrooms and 2 bathrooms, and are offered under plan PP-B. Both are available.

Q11. There are two two-bedroom apartments in Saffron Heights. Why do their prices differ? The standard unit (HCR-RWP-0202) costs PKR 14,750,000. The corner unit (HCR-RWP-0203) costs PKR 15,250,000, because of its corner windows. Each measures 4 marla (1,089 sq ft), and both are planned for handover on 31 August 2027 under plan PP-C.

Q12. Which properties will be handed over first? The earliest handover date among available properties is 31 December 2026. It applies to Plot H-21 in Hilltop Enclave (HCR-ISB-0108) and Plot P-12 in Pine Ridge Plots (HCR-ATD-0303). The latest date in the whole inventory is 30 September 2029, for the Lotus Gardens penthouse.

Q13. Is there a discount for buyers who decide quickly? Yes. A buyer who pays the booking token within 7 days of the first viewing gets 20% off the buying commission. On HCR-RWP-0202 the commission of PKR 258,125 falls by PKR 51,625 to PKR 206,500. The discount does not touch the admin fee or other charges.

Q14. Can I get a discount because a friend recommended the company? Yes. A client introduced by an existing client receives 10% off the commission, with a ceiling of PKR 75,000. A client who qualifies for both the referral discount and the early-bird discount cannot add them together; the larger one is applied.

4. Selling

Q15. How does the company sell my property? A consultant prepares the listing, photographs and describes the property, shows it to interested buyers, attends the viewings and presents each offer to you. You decide whether to accept any offer. The work is done under a written listing agreement.

Q16. How long does the listing agreement last, and can I end it early? The agreement lasts 90 days and can be renewed. If you wish to cancel it, send 7 days written notice.

Q17. What does the company charge a seller? The selling commission is one flat percentage of the sale price: 2.5% up to PKR 10,000,000, 2.25% from PKR 10,000,001 to PKR 25,000,000, and 2.0% above PKR 25,000,000. The minimum is PKR 200,000, and an admin fee of PKR 7,500 applies per transaction.

Q18. What would I pay if I sold a property for PKR 20,000,000? The price falls in the middle band, so the rate is 2.25%. The commission is PKR 20,000,000 x 2.25% = PKR 450,000. With the admin fee of PKR 7,500, the total is PKR 457,500.

Q19. What if my property sells for a low price? The minimum protects the company on small sales. For a sale at PKR 6,000,000, the percentage would give PKR 150,000, which is under the minimum, so the commission is PKR 200,000.

Q20. Should I get a valuation before I list? Many owners do, because a written value helps them set a realistic asking price. The valuation department reports separately from the sales teams, so its figure is not shaped by any commission. See the valuation questions below for the fees.

5. Renting and property management

Q21. How does the company handle a rental? The consultant advertises the unit, shows it, checks that landlord and tenant understand the terms and prepares the tenancy paperwork. Rental questions go to rentals@himalayacrest.example or +92 51 5550 1005.

Q22. Who pays the rental commission? Both sides share it equally. The landlord pays half of one month's rent and the tenant pays half of one month's rent. Each side pays at least PKR 10,000. On a rent of PKR 90,000, each side therefore pays PKR 45,000. On a rent of PKR 12,000, half would be PKR 6,000, so each side pays the PKR 10,000 minimum.

Q23. How big is the security deposit, and when do I get it back? The deposit is 2 months of rent. It is returned within 14 days after the tenant has handed the unit back.

Q24. How much notice must a tenant or landlord give? A tenant must give 30 days notice. A landlord who wants to end the tenancy must give 60 days notice.

Q25. Who pays for repairs? The tenant covers minor repairs up to PKR 10,000 per item. Larger repairs are the responsibility of the owner. Owners who use the management service can leave the coordination of repairs to the management team.

Q26. What does property management cost? The management fee is 8% of the monthly rent collected, with a minimum of PKR 6,000 per month. At a rent of PKR 150,000 the fee is PKR 12,000. At a rent of PKR 45,000, 8% would be PKR 3,600, which is below the minimum, so PKR 6,000 is charged. The two figures meet at a rent of PKR 75,000.

Q27. How can an owner end the management arrangement? Either side may end it by giving 45 days notice. Please send the notice to rentals@himalayacrest.example.

6. Payments and payment plans

Q28. How much is the booking token? The token is 2% of the property price. For HCR-RWP-0205 (price PKR 24,500,000) it is PKR 490,000. Since 1 January 2024 the rate has been 2%; an older rate that applied before that date is no longer in force.

Q29. Is the token an extra cost? No. The token is part of the price you pay, and it is counted toward your down payment. On HCR-ISB-0108, for example, the down payment is PKR 8,400,000, of which the token of PKR 420,000 is already paid, leaving PKR 7,980,000 to pay.

Q30. What payment plans are there?

Plan	Down payment	Instalments	Duration	Frequency	Surcharge
PP-A	40%	4	12 months	Quarterly	0%
PP-B	30%	8	24 months	Quarterly	4%
PP-C	20%	24	24 months	Monthly	6%
PP-D	25%	36	36 months	Monthly	9%

Each property is offered under one plan, which is shown in the Property Listings document.

Q31. How is the surcharge worked out? It is a percentage of the property price, added to the total you pay. On a PKR 10,000,000 property, plan PP-C adds PKR 600,000, so the total becomes PKR 10,600,000. Plan PP-A adds nothing.

Q32. What happens if I miss an instalment date? You have a grace period of 10 days after the due date. After that, a penalty of 0.1% of the overdue instalment is charged for each day, up to a ceiling of 5% of that instalment. On an overdue instalment of PKR 500,000, the penalty is PKR 500 per day and stops at PKR 25,000.

Q33. Can the company cancel my booking for non-payment? Only after an instalment has been overdue for 60 days and the company has given 15 days written notice.

Q34. Can I cancel a booking and get my money back? Yes, by written request emailed to bookings@himalayacrest.example. The refund depends on timing:

- Within 7 days of the booking date: the token is refunded less a 10% deduction, so 90% comes back.
- From day 8 to day 30: the token is refunded less a 50% deduction, so 50% comes back.
- After day 30: the token cannot be refunded.

Q35. What is the refund on a token of PKR 295,000 cancelled on day 10? Day 10 falls in the second window, so 50% is deducted. The refund is PKR 147,500.

Q36. What about money paid beyond the token? Amounts paid over and above the token are refunded less a 15% deduction. If you had paid PKR 2,000,000 beyond the token, you would receive PKR 1,700,000.

Q37. How long does a refund take? The refund is paid within 21 working days of approval. Working days are Monday to Friday.

Q38. Can I pass my booking to someone else? Yes, subject to a transfer fee of 1% of the property price, with a minimum of PKR 50,000. Transfers are not allowed in the first 30 days after booking, and processing takes 10 working days. For HCR-RWP-0205, the fee is 1% of PKR 24,500,000, which is PKR 245,000.

7. Documents and valuation

Q39. Which documents will I need to sign? The usual papers are the written agreement between buyer and seller, the registered sale deed, and the application to update the ownership record. The documentation team prepares and checks them. Where an owner appoints someone to act on their behalf, a power of attorney is prepared as well.

Q40. What does documentation support cost? The fee is PKR 35,000 per transaction, charged once regardless of how many papers are prepared. Discounts do not apply to it.

Q41. Can I use my own lawyer? Yes. Clients are free to appoint any lawyer, surveyor or contractor they prefer, and the company cooperates with whoever you choose. Northern Legal Associates can review agreements on request, but using them is optional.

Q42. Will I receive a receipt for every payment? Yes. The finance team issues a written receipt for each payment, and you should keep every one. Questions about receipts and refunds go to Usman Gillani at usman.gillani@himalayacrest.example or +92 51 5550 1017.

Q43. How much does a valuation cost? The fee depends on the property's value: PKR 15,000 up to PKR 10,000,000; PKR 25,000 from PKR 10,000,001 to PKR 25,000,000; and PKR 40,000 above PKR 25,000,000. Commercial properties add PKR 10,000. A valuation of a PKR 30,000,000 home costs PKR 40,000, and the same value for an office costs PKR 50,000.

Q44. Who signs the valuation reports? The Head of Valuation, Kamran Yousaf, signs every report. Requests go to valuation@himalayacrest.example or +92 51 5550 1004.

Q45. Does the company give investment advice? Yes. The advisory department, led from Lahore by Rabia Chaudhry, offers one-to-one sessions at PKR 20,000 per 60-minute session and a written portfolio review at PKR 60,000. Two sessions plus one review would cost PKR 100,000.

8. Viewings

Q46. How do I arrange a viewing? Call the branch that handles the property or ask your consultant. Apartments and houses in Islamabad are arranged through the Head Office on +92 51 5550 1001. Rawalpindi properties go through +92 51 5550 2001, Abbottabad through +92 992 5550 3001 and Lahore through +92 42 5550 4001.

Q47. What if I cannot attend? Please give at least 24 hours notice so the time slot can be offered to someone else. There is no charge for cancelling with proper notice.

Q48. Can I view a plot on my own? Plots are shown on site by arrangement. The branch will agree a meeting point with you and a consultant will accompany you.

Q49. Can I look at a reserved property? A reserved property cannot be booked unless the existing reservation is cancelled. The branch can note your interest and show a similar available unit meanwhile. For example, the reserved Block A three-bedroom apartment (HCR-ISB-0103) has an available Block B counterpart (HCR-ISB-0104).

9. Complaints and privacy

Q50. How do I make a complaint? Write to complaints@himalayacrest.example or call +92 51 5550 1003. The Compliance and Complaints Officer, Saima Iqbal (saima.iqbal@himalayacrest.example), records and tracks every complaint.

Q51. How quickly will I hear back? You will receive an acknowledgement within 2 working days. The company aims to resolve the complaint within 15 working days.

Q52. What if I am not satisfied with the outcome? If the complaint is still unresolved after 15 working days, you may escalate it to the Chief Operating Officer, Sana Qadri, who gives a decision within 5 working days. A final review by the Chief Executive Officer follows if needed, with a decision within 30 days of the escalation.

Q53. How long does the company keep my records? Records are retained for 7 years after your last transaction. Requests about your data go to privacy@himalayacrest.example.

10. Local terms

Q54. What is bayana? Bayana (also spelled bayanah or bayaana) is advance money paid to book a property. It is the same thing as the booking token, which is 2% of the price.

Q55. What are iqrarnama and registry? An iqrarnama (iqrar nama, ikrarnama) is the written agreement between buyer and seller. The registry (registri) is the registered sale deed that records the transfer.

Q56. What are intiqal and fard? Intiqal (intikal) is mutation, the update of the ownership record after a sale. A fard (fard-e-malkiyat) is an extract of the land record showing who the owner is.

Q57. What do kiraya, kiraydar and malik mean? Kiraya (kiraaya) is rent, a kiraydar (kirayedar) is a tenant and a malik is an owner.

Q58. What do qeemat, qist and rasid mean? Qeemat (keemat, qimat) is price, a qist (kist) is one instalment and a rasid (raseed) is a receipt.

Q59. What are a naqsha and a mukhtarnama? A naqsha (nakshah) is a site plan or layout map. A mukhtarnama (mukhtar nama) is a power of attorney document.

Q60. How big is a marla, a kanal, a lakh and a crore? One marla is 272.25 sq ft. One kanal is 20 marla, or 5,445 sq ft. A lakh is 100,000 and a crore is 10,000,000. So a 7 marla plot measures 1,906 sq ft, and a price of PKR 21,000,000 is PKR 2.1 crore.

11. Additional Information

Clients often ask whether the company charges extra for government fees. It does not collect them as company fees: government charges are payable by the client and are not included in company fees, and no rates are quoted in company documents.

Another frequent question is whether older figures still apply. They do not. The buying commission for the lowest price band was 2.5% until 28 February 2025 and has been 2.0% since 1 March 2025. The rental deposit used to be 3 months of rent until 31 May 2022 and is now 2 months. The late-payment penalty was 0.15% per day until 30 June 2023 and is now 0.1% per day. Please quote only the current values.

Finally, the first 7 days after booking are the cheapest time to change your mind: cancelling in that window returns 90% of the token, compared with 50% from day 8 to day 30. For a token of PKR 370,000, that is PKR 333,000 against PKR 185,000.